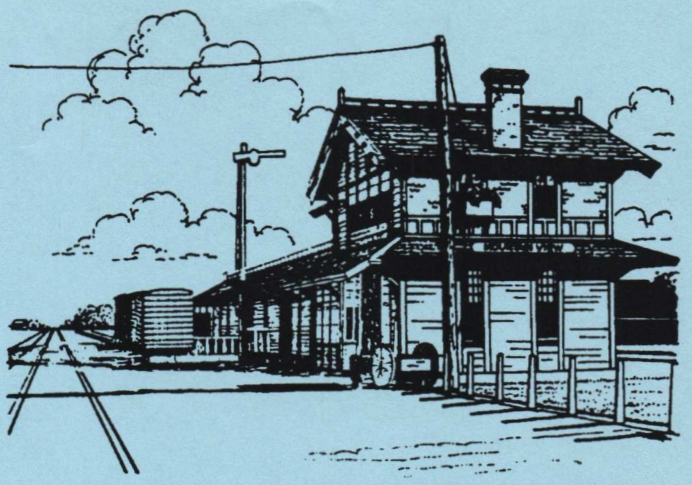
# Mountain View Historical Association Newsletter

P.O. Box 252
Mountain View, CA 94042

Hilton U. Brown, III - Editor



Southern Pacific Depot — Mountain View, California, built in 1888

## Celebrating the Adobe
## The November Meeting

The November, 1995 issue of the Mountain View Historical Association Newsletter featured an article *Save The Adobe Campaign Begins* by *Eva G. Mockbee*. The City Council had announced plans to demolish the Adobe Building. The building had served as a community facility, meeting hall, USO and teen center, and even as a National Guard Armory, but the costs of renovation and upgrading to modern building standards were deemed too high.

The Mountain View Historical Association asked the City for a reasonable amount of time to study costs of renovation, plans for fund-raising and possible uses for the restored building. Thus began the campaign to save and restore the Adobe.

The Historical Association spearheaded the creation of the *Save The Adobe Task Force*, which circulated petitions, established a speakers bureau, published brochures and established a presence at civic events of all kinds.

The May, 1998 issue of the Newsletter was able to report that the City Council had taken the fate of the Adobe Building under study and that the outlook was hopeful. Our optimism was confirmed with the inclusion of funding for the restoration of the Adobe Building in the 1998-1999 budget for the City.

At the August 1999 Historical Association Barbecue, Mark Rogge, the City Engineer managing the restoration of the Adobe Building shared with us details of the restoration and pleaded for help in finding pictures, programs, articles and artifacts from the early days of the Adobe which might be useful in the restoration.

This November, six years after the Mountain View Historical Association started the drive to *Save the Adobe* we will be meeting in the restored building. Our President is planning a program of reminisces from the early days, and "campaign stories" about the effort to bring about the restoration. He will perhaps even mention some of the people who made it happen!

***Celebrating the Adobe,***
Sunday November 4, 2001, 2:00 PM.
***At the Adobe***

## Dues are Due

See Page 6 for Details

## Barbecue & Raffle The August Meeting

The *Eighth Annual Barbecue & Raffle* for the Mountain View Historical Association took place Sunday August 5, 2001. To borrow a phrase or two – "The vittles we et were good, you bet, and the company was the same". Ralph Faravelli offers his thanks to the many people and organizations that supported barbecue in a letter printed elsewhere in this Newsletter. The financial results are also reported elsewhere. A fine party, and we are already looking forward to next year.

## Letter From the MVHA President Ralph Faravelli

Dear Members:

I would like to thank all our members who supported our recent BBQ. The BBQ event has become a great event, an afternoon of visiting with old friends and meeting new ones. The success of any event takes the hard work of many persons, and we are blessed that we have those types of members! Speaking of important help we have to recognize the wonderful food prepared by our cooks Al Jehning and his wife and their great cook in training, Matt Pear.

I would like all our members to support the following merchants that contributed either food or gift certificates to our annual fund raiser: Mtn. View Lock, Safeway stores, Albertons Markets, Round Table Pizza, Mountain View Performing Arts Center, The Boardwalk Restaurant, Sees Candies, Hobees Restaurant Armadillo Willys Restaurant, Century Theaters, Amicis East Coast Pizza, Noah's Bagels, Restaurant Don Giovanni, Vivaca Restaurant, Shoreline Golf, Burger King, Inc., Costco, Walmart, Boston Chicken, Krispie Kreme Donuts, In & Out Burger, Chevy's Restaurant, and Michael's Restaurant at Shoreline

Ralph Faravelli
President.

## Street Talk

Stanford Avenue, College Street, Leland Avenue and University Avenue are clustered together in what subdivision in Mountain View?

## Eighth Annual Barbecue & Raffle Accounting

| | |
|---|---|
| Income: | |
| 80 Adults, 1 Child | $ 805.00 |
| Raffle Proceeds | 290.00 |
| Expense: | |
| Flyer and Postage | 169.88 |
| Profit | $ 925.12 |

There would not be a profit without the generous support acknowledged in President Faravelli's letter, and there wouldn't have been an *Annual Barbecue and Raffle* without the dedication and hard work of many members of the Association.

## A Sign of the Times By Carol Fischer

In 1920 when Mountain View was a small town of about 2,000 citizens, a plan was formed to build two electric signs at the entrance to Castro Street at El Camino Real (then known as The Highway). The purpose of these signs was to advertise to travelers along The Highway that "Mountain View was a town and not a few cottages and a blacksmith shop".

Matt Burdett, a local blacksmith, was instrumental in fund-raising for the project. (Mr. Burdett lived on Hope Street, the site of today's Post Office). Citizens were asked to drop off their donations at Mountain View's two banks: The Farmers and Merchants Bank and the First National Bank, both located on Castro Street. Names of donors and their contributions were listed in the local newspaper. It was estimated that the project would cost 44,500 with each of the four pillars priced at 4100 a piece.

The City got into the spirit by purchasing two crescent pieces of land from Mr. Polley on one side and Mr. Graham on the other so that the entrance

would spread out in a fan configuration. Two iron, electrified signs that read "Mountain View" would be constructed on either side of Castro Street. Pillars mad of special rocks supported these signs. Iron seats or benches complemented the project so that local citizens could "wait for auto buses or watch traffic".

At least 30 individuals mad a long trek to the Pacific Ocean to gather unique rocks for the pillars. The January 21, 11921 headline of the local Mountain View Register Leader read: "Brave Men and Fair Women went down by the Sobbing Seas for to Gather Spoil unto Building Monuments". The group considered these stones distinctive "as they have been rolled and tossed about in the sea salt for 7 million years." After all the trucks and automobiles had been loaded, the crowd had a large picnic before heading back to Mountain View.

In May 1921, the signs were dedicated. A three-day carnival was held to commemorate the event and ro raise additional funds to pay for the new "monument". A motion picture was even made to capture the celebration!

These electric signs graced the corner of Castro and El Camino Real until 1962 when it became necessary to dismantle them in order to widen El Camino Real.

## In Commemoration

***Vivian Pritchett Goodwin*** — Born 1917, died April 1, 2001, in Smith River, CA. A former member of the MVHA and resident of Mountain View. Vivian's father, Frank Pritchett, founded Pritchett Electric which he sold to Ray Meyers and is now known as Meyer Appliances. Vivian is survived by her husband Leonard and her sister Doris Hansen of Smith River. Vivian taught music and was interested in many crafts. She also enjoyed the Sika Deer, Peacocks, Geese and other wildlife they had on their property.

## Executive Committee Meeting

The Executive Committee of the Mountain View Historical Association met on September 6, 2001. Financial reports, membership reports and Barbecue results were presented. Updated versions of this information is included elsewhere in this Newsletter.

Several actions were taken in regard to the Adobe Fund and the Adobe Building dedication.

- Funds were approved for the move of the Steirlin Credenza to the Adobe
- Funds for a suitable plaque to honor Engineer Mark Rogge were approved.
- Participation in the Adobe Dedication ceremonies were discussed.

The final draft of the Centennial Book will soon be ready for review. Publication will be overseen by the California History Center.

# Old Newspaper Items Compiled By Barbara Kinchen

***100 Years Ago (1901):*** The San Jose Mercury for December 22, 1901 carried a very interesting description of Mountain View. In 1902 the town was incorporated and next year there are many events planned to celebrate. This newspaper article gives a wonderful picture of what was here and some history of the area. Because of its length we will run some extracts for the next several issues.

## A PROSPEROUS COMMUNITY

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Mountain View is Growing
Vigorously in Business and Population

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It Lies in the Midst of Orchards, Vineyards and Broad Acres of Fertile Fields

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The town and district of Mountain View may be cited as a notable example of the development of Santa Clara county that has been going on during the last decade and in the first year of the new century. Other examples there are – villages that have sprung up in fields which until recently were devoted to stock raising or the growing of grain – but Mountain View was one of the first towns in the valley, and as for a quarter of a century it had remained practically stationary, the vigor of its later growth is all the more marked by contrast. That Mountain View was content for so many long years to doze in the sun and be comfortable was not due to any lack of local advantages. Quite the contrary, its apparent apathy grew out of the very richness and abundance of its natural resources. The early settlers were attracted there by the beauty of the landscape, the evenness of the climate, and the many evidences of an inexhaustible soil, and the cereal crops were so large and remunerative that the fortunate owners of ranches and farms in the district, supplied with all the comforts that rural life could afford, had no incentive to join in the stir and activities that characterize the life of the more modern community. But progress is a law of nature, and the placid existence of the farming element and of the little village which it sustained finally yielded to influences which had begun to transform the entire Santa Clara valley from a region of grain fields, pastures and natural parks of giant oaks to a vast stretch of orchards and vineyards whose fruits and wines have become a household word in every country in the civilized world.

Beautiful Environments

Mountain View is located in the Northwestern section of the county, about midway between the western range of mountains and the bay of San Francisco, the width of this section of the valley being 10 miles or more. The town is 11 miles from San Jose and 4 from Stanford University and gazing out from it at the magnificent sweep of mountains on either side of the valley one is struck with the significance of the name "Mountain View". The mountains, foothills, valley and bay by which the landscape is diversified make up a picture whose charm must be experienced to be realized, and once seen, the picture will never fade from memory.

Stevens and Permanenty creeks, both heading far back in the wooded canyons of the Santa Cruz range, flow by the town, emptying their waters into an arm of the bay. These streams are lined with oaks, maples, alders, sycamores and other timber, and they are among the best trout streams in the country, affording during the long summer months, sport and recreation for those who delight in outdoor life. There are many quail in the foothills, and a few deer still range the ridges and canyons sides within 5 or 10 miles of the town.

(WOW! – and this is just the introduction)

***50 Years Ago (1951):*** Sheriff's deputies raided the Bird Cage restaurant on El Camino Real and arrested three men for bookmaking. The next day each was fined $150.

Mrs. Millena "Millie" Waits was awarded her 50 year jewel by the Heremenia Rebekah Lodge.

Castro Street already has parking meters, but merchants are asking that they be installed on the side streets also. Too many all-day parkers fill the streets tying up spaces needed for regular shoppers.

New to the community:
-Ranch Shopping Center

-Rancho Village development
-Fanucci and Sons added a new showroom for Packard autos at El Camino Real and Castro Street where they have been in business for the last 30 years.
-Watch Hospital at 155 Castro
-B & K Sewing Center and Fireside Finance in the 800 block of Dana Street.
-Judo classes at 741 Villa taught by John and Tony Horillo.
-Meyer Electric moved from 147 Castro to 246 Castro.

The annual Halloween Costume Parade was sponsored by the city.

PFC Benny Esparza, 22, was reported killed in action in Korea. A wife and young daughter reside at 880 Washington Street.

The body of Air Force Lt. Col. Walter Kingsley Selenger was returned to the United States some six months after he was killed in a plane crash in Korea. His wife and two children, as well as his mother, reside in Mountain View.

After five local train-auto deaths within the last year and a warning from the State Public Utilities Commission, City Council voted to purchase and install reflectorized warning signals at the Castro Street railroad crossing. The Commission also recommended that flashing signals be installed at the Ada Avenue crossing or that the street be closed where it crosses the railroad tracks.

# New to the Mountain View History Center
## By Barbara Kinchen

***From Togo Nishiura:*** Four snapshots of Tri City (Japanese organization) floats from the 1950 and 1951 Harvest Festivals. Togo is a 1949 Mountain View High School grad, a math professor living in Indiana.

***From Mrs. Dorothy Bailey:*** A wooden barrel about two feet tall with the name Hartley Hardware along the side. This company occupied the Mockbee building at Castro Street and Villa from 1910 to 1923 and again fro 1926 to 1933 when it was purchase by Mountain View Hardware.

## Treasurer's Report
## Hilton Brown

The financial status of the Mountain View Historical Association is presented in the tables below. Primary sources of revenue for the Association are Annual Dues which arrive primarily in the fourth quarter, net income from special events such as the annual Small Brewers Festival and the Annual Barbecue, Life Memberships, Merchandise Sales, and Donations. An important additional source is major Grants and Gifts such as the Arrillaga and Peery Foundation's grant to support publication of the History of Mountain View. Interest on the Association's CDs is entered upon the maturity of each CD. CDs are usually rolled over upon maturity. Equity increased by $ 326.74 during the third quarter, and will increase substantially during the fourth quarter.

## Income & Expense
### July 1, 2001 - September 30, 2001

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| Opening Balance - 7/1/2001 | | $ 65,633.54 |
| Income | | |
| Annual Dues | $ 37.00 | |
| Interest | 587.61 | |
| Memorial Fund | 25.00 | |
| Total Income | | 649.61 |
| Expense | | |
| Business Expense | | |
| Meeting Expense | 169.88 | |
| Membership Expense | 44.11 | |
| Newsletter Expense | 294.30 | |
| Total Business Expense | | 508.29 |
| Ending Balance - 9/30/2001 | | $ 65,799.28 |

## Fund Balances
## September 30, 2001

Fund Balances

| | |
|---|---|
| Adobe Fund | $ 1,078.73 |
| Life Member Fund | 7,755.00 |
| Memorial Fund | 544.14 |
| Operating Reserve Fund | 3,000.00 |
| Significant Debts Payable | 1,218.75 |
| Publication Fund | 50,000.00 |
| Unencumbered (Equity) | 2,202.66 |
| Total Funds - 9/30/2001 | $ 65,799.28 |

## Disposition of Funds
## September 30, 2001

| | |
|---|---|
| Bank of Los Altos Checking | $ 12,173.99 |
| Petty Cash | 100.00 |
| Bank of Los Altos CDs | 53,525.29 |
| Total Disposition - 9/30/2001 | $65,799.28 |

## Notice – Dues are Due

Dues are now payable for the year 2002. The white mailing label on the outside of your Newsletter indicates the year thru which your dues are paid. The year is the number in square brackets, for example [2001]. If the number is 2002 or higher, your dues are paid. If the number is 2001 or lower, dues are due! The code in the adjacent brackets indicates your membership class. [AS] is single membership, $7.00 per year. [AF] is family membership, $10.00 per year. If your code is [LM], your dues are prepaid for life. A return envelope is enclosed for your convenience. Thank you!

## Membership Report
## June Casey

Dues are $ 7.00 per year for an individual or $ 10.00 per year for a family membership. Life memberships are available for $ 100.00 per person.

| | |
|---|---|
| Life Members | 93 |
| Special Member | 1 |
| Honored Member | 1 |
| Annual Memberships | 188 |
| Total Memberships | 283 |

New Members
- Alison Hicks
- Marlene Douglas
- Kathleen L. Raymond

## Association Officers And Executive Committee

| | |
|---|---|
| President | Ralph Faravelli |
| Past President & Social | Wally Erichsen |
| Vice President | Craig Holden |
| Sergeant At Arms | John Viscovich |
| Secretary | Margaret Peterson |
| Treasurer & Editor | Hilton Brown |
| Membership | June Casey |
| Programs and Publicity | Liz & Mario Ambra |
| Hospitality | Elizabeth Engberg |
| Memorial/Remembrance | Edna Thompson |
| Ways & Means | Pat Figueroa |
| Historical Data | Barbara Kinchen |
| Amplification/Recording | Albert Jehning |

Regular meetings of the Mountain View Historical Association are held on the first Sunday of February, May, August and November. The Newsletter is mailed approximately two weeks before each meeting. Deadline for copy for the Newsletter is the third Sunday before each meeting.

## Life, Honored and Special Members

*Honored Member*

Chris Castro

*Special Member*

Lena Alameda

*Life Members*

O. Lennart Ahlkvist
Mario Ambra
May E. Armanini
John Arrillaga
Marge Hingsberger Bailey
Godfrey Baumgartner
Flora T. Brown
Hilton U. Brown, III
Mary Ann Meek Buswell
Alice Churin Carvo
June Casey
William A. Dale
June Redwine de Larios
Cliff Del Carlo
Joseph Diaz
Kevin C. Duggan
Doris Ebere
Ruth Erichsen
Wallace J. Erichsen
Carmen Faravelli
Ralph Faravelli
Roger Fellows
Patricia Figueroa
Carol Fischer
Tom Frankum
Marion Grimm
Estelle Stagg Heffelfinger
Edward Henderson
Eleanor McGlynn Henderson
William Henderson
Charles Hirschbek
Norene Hogle
Audrey Jarvis Hoke
Alice Holden
George Holden
Donald M. Holt
Virginia M. Holt
George Jagels
Harold Jarvis
Al Jehning
Leo E. Kalcic
R. Michael Kasperzak Jr.
Robert W. Kirby
Joe Kleitman
Helen Shearer Krogh
Barbara Krzyczkowska
Holly Urban Moore Leonard
Madeline Chargon Malovos
Thomas E. Miller
Frances Churin Mills
Eva Mockbee
Betty C. Monroe
Gail Urban Moore
LaVerna Vincent Morgan
Mimi Mourkas
Don Newfarmer
Anne G. Nichols
Nancy Noe
Richard J. Peery
Harry Pinto
Ida Pinto
Milan Popovich
Massimo Prati
John P. Puppo
Louis F. Renner
Patricia J. Reyburn
Mark Rogge
Vivian Schatz
Robert C. Schick
Elaine Marcetti Shearer
Nancy L. Smith
Richard M. Smith
Martin J. Spangler
Austin Spencer
Honor Spitz
Brigitte Stafford
J. R. Stafford
H. Lee Stillens
Linda Swan
Joseph Sweeney
Roberta Sweeney
Sally Moore Taboada
H. (Hip) A. Telmont
Edna Thompson
John Viscovich
Arthur Walton
Patricia Walton
Paula Weaver
Robert Weaver
Denise Williams
Bill Wissel
Lorraine A. Wormald
Mary Lou Zoglin

# Mountain View Historical Association

## *Regular Meeting*

## *Celebrating The Adobe*

**Sunday**
**November 4, 2001**
**2:00 P.M.**
**At The Adobe Building**

**Corner of**
**Moffett Blvd and**
**Central Expressway**

**Membership:** Any person who signifies interest in the aims of this Association and who pays the specified annual dues may become a member of the Association.

**Aims:** The aims of this Association are: to gather and preserve historical data relative to the early settlement and development of the area in and around the present City of Mountain View; to collect, record, edit and publish a history of the pioneering activities of this area; to preserve historic objects and places; to cooperate with other organizations in the Santa Clara Valley on projects deemed worthy by our membership.

**MEMBERSHIP APPLICATION**

NAME: _____

ADDRESS: _____

_____

_____

TELEPHONE: _____

*TYPE:* NEW____ RENEWAL____
Regular Member $ 7.00/yr
Family Membership $10.00/yr
Life Member $100.00.

*Make Check Payable to:*
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P.O. Box 252, Mountain View, CA 94042

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**Mountain View, CA 94042**

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